tuition, books and meals. The inputs produced attendance. However, enrolment and attendance did not equal learning and quality of education.

New Education Policy, 2020 (NEP-2020) Brings about Some Structural Changes

The government adopted the New Education Policy in 2020 (NEP-2020).

The Policy proposes 'revision and revamping of all aspects of the education structure, including its regulation and governance, to create a new system that is aligned with the aspirational goals of twenty-first century education, including SDG4 [Sustainable Development Goal 4], while building upon India's traditions and value systems.'

The largest structural change planned is in the school system.

The current system of 10+2 (ten years of common school education and two years of selective subject education) is to be replaced by a four-tiered 5+3+3+4 education system. The new system proposes to integrate three years of early childhood education delivered in the *anganwadi*/preschool/*balvatika* system with two years of current primary education into 'foundational' education. The remaining three years of current primary school (1–5 grade) is being broken into two years of foundational and three years of 'preparatory' schooling. The envisaged third tier of three years of schooling (6–8 grade) corresponds with present-day upper primary schooling. Two years of education (currently part of secondary education in 9–10 grade) and two years of senior secondary education (11–12 grade) are being combined in the fourth tier of secondary education. The new system formalizes early childhood education by combining the present informal educational arrangement for preschool (before a child turns six) in playschools, anganwadis and other miscellaneous arrangements with two years of formal schooling.

The second structural change is to create a system of school complexes/clusters to group one secondary school with all other schools